

Kamal Joshi

Staff Software Engineer | Go | AWS | Distributed Systems | AI-Assisted Engineering

Austin, TX | Austin HQ hybrid-eligible

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff software engineer and technical leader with deep experience leading ambiguous, complex problem spaces from design through production in SaaS platform environments. Track record of influencing architectural decisions across teams, navigating short-term delivery pressure against long-term system health, and mentoring engineers to grow in ownership and craft. I integrate AI coding assistants and LLMs proficiently into my daily workflow — with the critical judgment to verify AI-generated outputs for security, performance, and accuracy — allowing me to focus on high-impact architectural and strategic challenges while maintaining quality standards.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Software architecture & system design:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, gRPC, REST/JSON APIs, distributed systems, service-oriented architectures, event-driven microservices, trade-off analysis
- **AWS & cloud infrastructure:** Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- **Technical leadership:** ambiguous problem leadership, cross-team design influence, production ownership, incident response, stakeholder alignment
- **Mentoring & engineering culture:** code review, design discussions, team planning, knowledge-sharing forums, internal library development
- **AI-assisted development:** daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex — with critical verification discipline; pioneered team-wide AI tooling adoption
- **Full-stack breadth:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Angular; database systems (DynamoDB, SQL, OpenTSDB); secure coding practices

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Led design and delivery of complex, ambiguous platform problems for Cisco Secure Access, owning the **API Gateway, Authorization Service**, and **Third-Party Integrations Service** from discovery through production.
- Navigated a high-ambiguity project to **alpha delivery on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three — leading the push security events capability using the CloudEvents standard, delivering high value to customers on a committed timeline.
- Resolved a critical production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 organizations**, and executing a full redrive within **5-10 minutes** — diagnosing across multiple levels of the stack.
- Provided system-wide design guidance by reframing API onboarding as a control-plane architecture problem, proposing a hybrid model that balanced self-service speed with auditability — **influencing the product roadmap** through technical clarity.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key authentication and rate-limit behavior, driving durable architectural fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Led cross-service design for **Splunk** and **CloudEvents** webhook delivery formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications — coordinating four teams to a shared API contract.
- Diagnosed and fixed a Jamf / Intune integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation, **contributing directly to the customer's purchase decision**.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Built **auth-tools**, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services — a deliberate trade-off favoring long-term maintainability and reuse over short-term speed.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design discussions, and team planning; initiated **Tip Talk Tue**, a recurring knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and security practices.
- Pioneered team-wide **GitHub Copilot** adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives; integrated Claude Code and Codex into daily workflows with a verification-first discipline — advancing the team from passive consumers to active, quality-conscious AI practitioners.
- Led **ISMAP security certification** end-to-end, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements and meeting all deadlines.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for a cloud-native data ingestion platform; built OIDC/OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorization flows.
- Contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs from SQL schemas, making the right trade-off between consistency and implementation speed.
- Designed a type-assisted search feature for an Active Threat Analytics dashboard, turning a complex querying workflow into a low-friction experience for security analysts.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, workflow applications, and integrations across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector software products.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, database systems, service integrations, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University